

Ilorin Innovation Hub – Monthly Report

Submitted to: IHS Nigeria

Reporting Period: February 2026

Submitted by: Managing Director

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1. Executive Summary

February 2026 was a productive and high-energy month for Ilorin Innovation Hub (IIH), marked by the full-scale commencement of the Learn2Earn Fellowship, significant ecosystem engagement through the AI in Nigeria InnovateAI Summit, and continued acceleration of ongoing programmes. The Hub served as the Ilorin Experience Centre for the InnovateAI Summit, connecting over 200 community members to the national AI dialogue. The Learn2Earn Fellowship officially commenced on February 9, with 171 fellows beginning foundational learning modules in structured prompting, programming concepts, and project-based learning.

Across all programmes, the Hub recorded 253 total attendees, with a participation rate of 71% for virtual events and 48% for physical events. The Builder's Path session on entrepreneurial resilience attracted 22 participants, while the Accelerator cohort of 9 startups continued advancing toward Demo Day, with multiple startups engaged in active pilot engagements and validation activities with IHS. The DBN Entrepreneurship Training Programme (ETP 8.0) mobilization continued, with 171 MSMEs registered for the upcoming training rollout.

Facility operations were highly active, supporting the Learn2Earn orientation (February 2–6) and subsequent daily training sessions, the Ministry of Livestock Development event (February 10), and the AI in Nigeria Conference (February 20). Infrastructure improvements included AC maintenance, electrical upgrades in the American Corner, hand dryer installation, plumbing repairs, and solar system management, all ensuring uninterrupted service delivery.

From a financial perspective, February 2026 reflected substantial operational activity, with income driven primarily by partner operational funding from UNDP and the IHS-supported Ilorin Fellows lunch programme. Notable inflows during the month included Ilorin Fellows programme funding of ₦8,850,000.00 and UNDP operational funding of ₦7,680,000.00. Expenditure was directed toward staff salaries and payroll, statutory pension and NHF contributions, security and facility maintenance, and programme support costs. The Hub maintained a positive net cash position for the month. Cafeteria operations under BOA Foods continued to perform well, with steady in-store and drinks sales activity bolstered by the increased footfall from the Learn2Earn Fellowship.

The Managing Director led significant strategic engagements during the month, including moderating a panel session at the AI in Nigeria InnovateAI Summit as the Ilorin remote location representative, and participating in Web Summit Qatar alongside the Deputy Managing Director, where connections were established with QSTP (Qatar Science and Technology Park) on proposed joint programming. These engagements further position IIH as a leading voice in the African AI and innovation ecosystem.

2. Programs & Events Report

Month Overview

February 2026 recorded a total of 253 attendees across physical and virtual sessions. The month centred on operationalising the Learn2Earn Fellowship, deepening accelerator cohort engagement with IHS, and connecting the Ilorin ecosystem to the national AI conversation through the InnovateAI Summit. Virtual programme attendance reached 71% of the target, while physical attendance tracked at 48%.

Key Activities Conducted

Programme / Event	Format	Key Metrics	Focus Area	Outcomes / Impact
Builder's Path (CcHUB)	Physical	22 participants	Entrepreneurial Resilience & Founder Development	Fireside chat on navigating business setbacks and rebuilding ventures; strengthened peer learning and founder engagement within the IIH community
InnovateAI Summit – Ilorin Experience Centre (IIH)	Hybrid (Virtual link-up)	200+ participants	AI Ecosystem Development & National Dialogue	IIH hosted the Ilorin remote hub for the national AI in Nigeria conference; MD moderated a panel session, positioning IIH as a key voice in Nigeria's AI conversation
Learn2Earn Fellowship Orientation & Training (Future Africa)	Physical	171 fellows	Talent Development & Digital Skills	Fellowship commenced February 9; fellows began structured prompting, programming, and project-based learning; daily meal provision supported attendance stability



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Accelerator Programme (Future Africa)	Physical	9 startups	Startup Acceleration & Investment Readiness	Cohort advanced toward Demo Day; multiple startups (enee.io, Gauge, Insight Works, Flowsoft, Movvn, POD, SPCTA, PERWER, GoChargeAm) engaged in IHS pilot validations; PERWER, GoChargeAm, POD, and Gauge pitched at Africa Deep Tech Foundation Conference Demo Day
Pre-Incubation & Incubation Programme (CcHUB)	Physical (evening slots)	9 pre-incubation + 5 incubation	Venture Development & Investment Readiness	Session schedules adjusted to evening slots; milestone review panel conducted; revised milestone submissions received and under evaluation
Animate Africa 3D Training (CcHUB)	Hybrid	~50 active learners (from 279)	Creative Technology & Digital Skills	AMA session held; 12 learners attended and expressed preference for more physical sessions; learner commitment and engagement being reassessed
DBN ETP 8.0 Mobilization (IIH)	Hybrid	171 MSMEs registered	MSME Development & Financial Inclusion	Continued mobilization as Kwara State training centre; awareness campaigns ongoing to expand participation

				ahead of training rollout
Ministry of Livestock Development Event	Physical	Government event (Feb 10)	Government Partnership & Facility Rental	Big Hall prepared and managed; generated meeting room facility revenue

Participation Metrics

Metric	Value
Total Programme Registrations	512
Monthly Physical Programme Attendance	231
Monthly Virtual Programme Attendance	22
Overall Monthly Programme Attendance	253
Virtual Event Attendance Rate	71% (Target: 33%)
Physical Event Attendance Rate	48% (Target: 50%)

Projected Impact

The Learn2Earn Fellowship, with 171 fellows engaged from day one, represents a major talent development pipeline that will generate measurable digital skills outcomes over the 24-month programme.

Active IHS pilot engagements by 6+ accelerator startups signal a strong probability of commercial partnerships and investment-ready ventures at the upcoming Demo Day.

IIH's role as the Ilorin Experience Centre for the InnovateAI Summit expanded the Hub's national profile and positioned it as the leading AI ecosystem node in Kwara State.

The DBN ETP 8.0 mobilization with 171 MSMEs registered sets the foundation for a large-scale economic impact programme targeting 3,000 MSMEs across Kwara State.

Upcoming Activities

CcHUB: Ilorin DevBox launch; HERizon programme; continued Animate Africa training
Future Africa: Accelerator Demo Day planning; Learn2Earn Fellowship ongoing training (Phase 2 modules)

IIH: DBN ETP 8.0 full-scale rollout; IIH-IHS Demo Day (March 2026); continued ecosystem engagement

MD's Office: Follow-up engagement with QSTP on joint programming; Africa Deep Tech Foundation partnership development; IIH-IHS Demo Day preparations

3. Operations Report

3.1 Finances

February 2026 financial operations reflected significant activity across programme funding, staff costs, and facility operations. The Hub received substantial partner funding for the Ilorin Fellows Learn2Earn lunch programme and ongoing UNDP/IHS operational support. Financial data is

sourced from the IIH Financial Management Report template covering transactions across both PremiumTrust (main operational) and Zenith (facility rentals & cafeteria) bank accounts.

Income Breakdown – February 2026

Category	Details	Amount (₦)
Partner operational funding	UNDP/IHS operational funding (NISS); Paystack/Ilorin Fellows 20-day lunch programme	₦16,530,000.00
Cafeteria revenue (BOA Jan drinks settlement)	BOA Foods January 2026 drinks sales settlement	₦197,200.00
Facility rentals	Meeting room bookings (Tunmise Johnson Household Foundation; Dews Logistics)	₦100,000.00
Total Income – February 2026		₦16,827,200.00

Expenditure Breakdown – February 2026

Category	Details	Amount (₦)
Staff salaries & wages	Monthly payroll for 29 staff	₦7,858,718.74
Staff pension, NSITF & NHF	Statutory pension, NSITF, and NHF contributions	₦2,174,036.25
Repairs & maintenance	Security services, facility repairs, electrical upgrades, and AC maintenance	₦1,970,800.00
Janitorial services	Monthly cleaning and sanitation services	₦1,370,000.00
Staff welfare & allowances	NYSC stipends, intern allowances, and staff welfare payments	₦1,253,707.34
Other expenses	Consulting, vendor services, and miscellaneous	₦403,050.00
Guest entertainment & cafeteria purchases	Drinks, refreshments, and cafeteria stock purchases	₦319,600.00
Travel expense		₦280,506.98
Fuel & diesel	Generator fuel and vehicle mileage	₦150,000.00
Office supplies	Stationery and office consumables	₦31,500.00
Bank fees & charges		₦10,089.99
Total Operational Expenditure – February 2026		₦15,822,009.30

Financial Summary – February 2026

Item	Amount (₦)
Total Reportable Income	₦16,827,200.00
Total Operational Expenditure	₦15,822,009.30
Net Position	₦1,005,190.70

3.2 Cafeteria Operations & Profit Sharing

The IIH Cafeteria, operated by BOA Foods Restaurant under a profit-sharing arrangement, served the Hub community throughout February 2026. Operations covered both in-store food sales and drinks/beverages provision. Cafeteria-related purchases (drinks, refreshments) are recorded as expenses from the Zenith bank account, while revenue and profit sharing are reported from BOA Foods' monthly sales reports.

Overview

Under the existing agreement, BOA Foods manages daily cafeteria operations while IIH receives a 20% share of gross profits. February 2026 operations benefited from the commencement of the Learn2Earn Fellowship, which significantly increased daily footfall and cafeteria activity throughout the month, with 20 active trading days recorded.

In-Store Sales – Profit & Loss Summary

Item	Amount (₦)
Revenue (In-Store Sales)	₦1,566,300.00
Cost of Sales	₦1,337,700.00
Gross Profit	₦228,600.00
IIH Share (20%)	₦45,720.00

Drinks Sales

In addition to in-store food sales, the cafeteria recorded drinks sales (PET water at ₦200, Maltina at ₦600, and PET 600ml at ₦600) totalling ₦344,400.00 for February 2026, across 20 active trading days. The Learn2Earn Fellowship programme significantly boosted daily drinks sales volume throughout the month.

Profit Sharing Breakdown

Partner	Share (%)	Amount (₦)
BOA Foods	80%	₦182,880.00
IIH Cafeteria	20%	₦45,720.00
Total Gross Profit	100%	₦228,600.00

3.3 Administration

The Administration and Hospitality department maintained effective operational support throughout February 2026, supporting a high volume of programme activities, partner engagements, and facility events.

Front desk and visitor management: Managed daily visitor flow with professional reception, proper documentation, and prompt handling of official correspondence, enquiries, and invitations from innovators and prospective clients.

Event and partner support: Coordinated logistics, refreshments, and on-site assistance for training sessions, workshops, and partner engagements including the Learn2Earn Fellowship (ongoing support), the Ministry of Livestock Development event (February 10), and the AI in Nigeria Conference (February 20). Ensured boardroom readiness and refreshments for all client meetings.

Procurement and vendor coordination: Managed procurement of office supplies and VIP Lounge items; reviewed and processed invoices, payments, and refunds to maintain positive vendor relationships and ensure timely delivery of goods and services.

Facility and janitorial oversight: Supervised janitorial services and ensured consistent readiness of the VIP Lounge and all Hub spaces throughout the high-activity month.

Administrative coordination: Responded to internal and external enquiries promptly; maintained coordination with relevant teams on payments and operational activities; processed security deposit refunds in support of positive client relations.

Recommendation

Engage temporary support staff during large-scale events to assist with logistics and inventory handling, ensuring adequate coverage without overburdening core administrative staff.

3.4 Human Resources (HR)

The HR department maintained stable operations in February 2026, with continued focus on workforce management, employee welfare, and administrative coordination.

Workforce Summary

Permanent Staff: 16

Contract Staff: 3

NYSC Corps Members: 7

Interns: 3

Total Workforce: 29

Key Activities

Onboarded one NYSC corps member and one intern; processed exit of one intern whose engagement period was completed.

Facilitated a training and knowledge-sharing session for staff and corps members in collaboration with the IHS team, providing valuable industry insights and professional development opportunities.

Continued the ongoing recruitment process for the IHS project, coordinating candidate sourcing and engagement in line with project requirements.

Salaries, allowances, and stipends were processed and paid on schedule for all staff categories in line with organizational policies.

Maintained routine monitoring of staff attendance, task execution, productivity, and welfare; no significant disciplinary or performance concerns were recorded.

3.5 Facility Management & Infrastructure

February 2026 was a highly active month for facility operations, with the department managing simultaneous programmes, infrastructure upgrades, and recurring maintenance activities. Key events supported included the Learn2Earn Orientation (February 2–6), the Ministry of Livestock Development Event (February 10), and the AI in Nigeria Conference (February 20), all conducted without major operational disruption.



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Key Activities and Achievements

Learn2Earn Orientation & Training Support (February 2–6, then daily): Managed full hall setup including seating arrangement, power distribution, IT connectivity, and daily cleanliness for the Big Hall and General Workspace. Developed a device tracking record system for Learn2Earn computer management and completed equipment tagging for inventory accountability.

AI in Nigeria Conference (February 20): Coordinated full technical setup in the Big Hall including live streaming link-up from Lagos, lighting, sound, power distribution, and IT connectivity. Janitorial staff maintained standards throughout; security managed access control.

Ministry of Livestock Development Event (February 10): Prepared the Big Hall with seating and projection setup; coordinated janitorial and security support.

Air Conditioning Maintenance: Conducted comprehensive AC servicing across VIP area, main hall, and offices — including gas refill, leak repair, filter cleaning, and unit performance testing (February 12, 16, 26, 27, 28). All AC units restored to full operational status.

Electrical Upgrades: Installed additional power sockets in the American Corner to support high device load during Learn2Earn training; resolved electrical faults through rerouting and inspection. Repaired lighting deficiencies in security houses, Facility Office, and small Hub structures.

Plumbing & Restroom Improvements: Installed hand dryers in the downstairs restroom (February 4) to improve hygiene; repaired the pressing tap in the upstairs restroom (February 24); built a demarcation for the ablution spot to improve sanitation and organisation.

Furniture & Workspace Management: Repaired and replaced central and round sofas; flagged and arranged corrective action for multipurpose and ergonomic chairs; reorganised workspaces for optimal participant comfort during high-volume training days.

Solar & Outdoor Infrastructure: Relocated and repaired faulty solar system components; removed damaged garden lights to ensure safety; replaced the national flag for proper display.

3.6 IT & Marketing

February 2026 was an intensive month for the IT and Marketing department, driven by the commencement of the Learn2Earn Fellowship, the InnovateAI Summit, and ongoing infrastructure strengthening. The department delivered reliable technical support across all programmes while executing a comprehensive digital marketing and communications agenda.

Technical Support & Infrastructure

Provided continuous technical support for the Learn2Earn Fellowship throughout the month, including system setup, participant assistance, troubleshooting, session monitoring, and hotspot authentication implementation for secure internet access.

Supported the AI in Nigeria InnovateAI Conference (February 20) with technical setup, system configuration, live streaming connectivity, equipment coordination, and troubleshooting.



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Implemented organisation-wide internet access restrictions to improve network efficiency, monitoring, and security; worked alongside an external engineer to configure the Huawei MTN router and finalize internal network administration.

Configured the MikroTik router to support Hub workspace application and optimized network performance for high-volume usage during Learn2Earn training.

Repaired 6 desktop computers and 2 staff laptops, reducing system downtime and improving staff productivity. Completed device tagging for the Learn2Earn computer lab.

Maintained uninterrupted operations through proactive solar power monitoring.

Digital Marketing & Communications

Designed and published IIH Newsletter (editions 1 & 2), IIH Newsletter Metrics graphic, 'What to Expect' graphic, IIH Insider design, and the IIH Demo Day graphic.

Created promotional assets for the DBN Entrepreneurship Training Programme (DBN 1 & DBN 2 graphics, ETP announcement design, Register/Upskill & Pitch graphic, and Grant/₦100M Funding graphic).

Amplified the AI in Nigeria InnovateAI Conference with dedicated promotional content and post-event success recap; strengthened IIH's positioning in AI ecosystem conversations and improved professional audience targeting.

Delivered design assets for the Builder's Path session, Ramadan Kareem community engagement, and Partnership development visual communications.

Maintained brand consistency across all digital channels, programmes, and partner materials; executed IIH screen design asset updates.

3.7 Managing Director's Office

The Managing Director's office remained active in strategic leadership, external engagement, and ecosystem representation throughout February 2026. Key activities included high-profile conference participation, international partnerships, and continued oversight of the Hub's strategic programmes.

AI in Nigeria InnovateAI Summit – Ilorin Remote Location & Panel Moderation: The MD led IIH's participation as the official Ilorin Experience Centre for the AI in Nigeria InnovateAI Summit on February 20. Over 200 community members gathered at the Hub to connect virtually with the Lagos-based national conference. The MD moderated a panel session at the event, with the Hub's involvement strengthening IIH's visibility as the leading AI ecosystem node in Kwara State and reinforcing its role in shaping Nigeria's national AI dialogue.

Web Summit Qatar Participation: The MD attended Web Summit Qatar alongside the Deputy Managing Director (Adebola), representing IIH at one of the world's most prominent technology and innovation conferences. The visit yielded a strategic connection with QSTP (Qatar Science and Technology Park) around proposed joint programming, opening a potential partnership pathway for collaborative innovation initiatives, knowledge exchange, and programme co-development between IIH and QSTP. Discussions on the scope and structure of joint programming are ongoing as follow-up engagement is being planned.



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Africa Deep Tech Foundation Conference Demo Day: Provided strategic oversight for the participation of four IIH Accelerator startups (PERWER, GoChargeAm, POD, and Gauge) who pitched their solutions at the Africa Deep Tech Foundation Conference Demo Day, advancing their investment readiness and ecosystem exposure.

IIH-IHS Demo Day Planning: Continued preparatory work for the Demo Day scheduled for March 2026, designed to showcase accelerator cohort progress and attract investor and partner interest in the ventures.

Board and Stakeholder Engagement: Maintained regular communication with the board and key stakeholders on Hub performance, strategic direction, and milestone achievements. Continued oversight of the Learn2Earn Fellowship commencement and IHS partnership programmes.

4. Conclusion

February 2026 marked a milestone month for Ilorin Innovation Hub, anchored by the successful commencement of the Learn2Earn Fellowship with 171 fellows, IIH's prominent role as the Ilorin Experience Centre for the national AI in Nigeria InnovateAI Summit, and continued acceleration of the Future Africa Accelerator cohort toward Demo Day. The month recorded 253 programme attendees and 512 total registrations across physical and virtual sessions, demonstrating sustained community engagement and programme momentum.

Operationally, the Hub managed an intensive schedule of simultaneous events and training programmes, with the Facility and IT departments ensuring uninterrupted service delivery through infrastructure upgrades, AC maintenance, network optimisation, and comprehensive technical support. Cafeteria operations under BOA Foods performed strongly across 20 trading days, reflecting the positive impact of increased Learn2Earn footfall on daily cafeteria activity.

The MD's participation in the AI in Nigeria InnovateAI Summit as a panel moderator and in Web Summit Qatar — where strategic connections with QSTP on proposed joint programming were established — positions IIH for new international partnership opportunities and further elevates the Hub's global innovation profile.

There was also a lot of interaction with the IHS Nigeria leadership and team on correcting our organizational structure, staff grades and processes. This also led to deliberation on potential new hires based on current hub needs and activities.

Looking ahead to March 2026, key priorities include the IIH-IHS Demo Day showcasing Accelerator cohort progress to investors, the continuation of the Learn2Earn Fellowship Phase 2 modules, the full-scale rollout of the DBN ETP 8.0 training programme, and follow-up engagement with QSTP on joint programming. The Hub remains committed to delivering programme excellence, operational resilience, and the advancement of its strategic mission to foster innovation and economic development in Ilorin and across Kwara State.



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